Justin Telmo

Senior Back-End & Full-Stack Engineer · PHP, Kotlin, & Cloud Infrastructure

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SUMMARY

Senior Back-End & Full-Stack Engineer with 13+ years of experience building, migrating, and scaling robust web applications and microservices. Expert in the **PHP ecosystem (Laravel, Symfony)** and modern back-end environments (Kotlin, Node.js, Spring Boot). Proven track record of executing monolithic migrations, optimizing server response times by 50%+, and managing distributed cloud systems on **AWS**. Power user of AI acceleration to drive velocity and code quality.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages:	**PHP (5.x/7.x/8.x)**, Kotlin, C#, SQL (MySQL/PostgreSQL), JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, C++	**Cloud & DevOps:**	AWS (ECS, EventBridge, CloudFront, IAM), Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Git
Backend & Libs:	**Laravel**, **Symfony**, Node.js, Spring Boot, Composer, RESTful APIs, OOP, Design Patterns	**Testing & Tools:**	PHPUnit, Cypress, Charles Proxy, SonarQube, Perforce, Claude Code, Redis, Memcached

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Game Band — 03/2025 – 02/2026

Senior Back-End & Full-Stack Engineer · Dead Man's Party: A Knives Out Game (Netflix Interactive TV)

- Pioneered **first-of-its-kind Netflix SDK integration** for phone-as-controller gameplay via QR pairing and WebGL.
- **Reduced initial load time by 60%+** (10s to <4s) via asset bundle restructuring and async localized asset loading.
- Architected device communication backbone and designed a full 12-language async localization pipeline.
- Integrated Netflix Haptics API for vibration events synchronized with live TV gameplay.

The Game Band — 04/2024 – 03/2025

Senior Back-End & Full-Stack Engineer · Unreleased Title

- Architected core back-end systems and build infrastructure using **Docker, AWS, and Jenkins**, automating REST API endpoints.
- Developed high-performance back-end microservices in **Kotlin** to track player voting, achievements, and purchases.
- Integrated a large language model API wrapper to manage dynamic story beats and AI-driven dialogue.

Pixelberry Studios — 04/2023 – 03/2024

Full-Stack Engineer II · StoryLoom

- Launched StoryLoom globally; built lightweight React/Vite mobile client **reducing app size by >50%**.
- Managed and scaled multiple Node.js microservices on **AWS and Docker** to support thousands of daily active users.
- Leveraged **JSBridge** for secure, seamless web-to-native communication between React frontend and Unity client.

Electronic Arts / Glu Mobile — 10/2018 – 11/2022

Server Software Engineer II · Covet Fashion

- **Led PHP-to-Kotlin Migration:** Migrated core features from a legacy monolithic PHP codebase to Kotlin microservices.
- **Optimized Server Response Times:** Migrated core server platform from **PHP 5 to PHP 7.2**, reducing latency and server response times by **>50%**.
- **Drove Subscription Revenue:** Architected subscription microservices handling iOS/Android entitlements, contributing to a **30% revenue increase** during the studio's record year.
- Improved Day 30 retention by 15% via New User Flow revamp; built CI/CD pipelines using **GitLab CI, AWS ECS, and Jenkins**.
- Mentored interns and junior engineers, supporting standard engineering practices and team velocity.

KIXEYE — 05/2016 – 07/2018

Game & Backend Engineer · Battle Pirates

- Maintained high-volume **PHP backend**, C++ real-time matchmaking service, and Python 3 chat service.
- Secured game revenue by implementing **server-authoritative models** to close critical vulnerabilities.
- Developed custom web-based content management tools for design and product teams using **MooTools and Handlebars**.
- Used Stage3D for 25% rendering gain and maintained code quality standards via **SonarQube** static analysis.

Big Fish Games / Self Aware Games — 10/2013 – 09/2015

Game Engineer (Big Fish Casino) / Junior Game Engineer (Big Fish Bingo)

- **Promoted to Game Engineer within one year** to lead features and backend logic for titles with **250k peak DAU**.
- Operated and scaled high-traffic backend stack of **PHP, MySQL, Redis, and Memcached** for real-time social gameplay.
- Built dynamic UI systems via Cocos2D-JS and integrated them with native iOS/Android client platforms.
- Reworked legacy backend systems and in-house tools to significantly reduce technical debt.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz — *B.S. Computer Science: Game Design*